

BibInVs MN 38

Zechariah

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 38*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Zechariah

Zechariah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the eighth month of the second year in the reign of Darius, GOD's Message came to the prophet Zechariah son of Berechiah, son of Iddo:
- 1 In the eighth month of the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came to the prophet Zechariah son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo:
- 2 "GOD was very angry with your ancestors.
- 2 The LORD was very angry with your forefathers.
- 3 So give to the people this Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: 'Come back to me and I'll come back to you.
- 3 Therefore tell the people: This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'Return to me,' declares the LORD Almighty, 'and I will return to you,' says the LORD Almighty.
- 4 Don't be like your parents. The old-time prophets called out to them, "A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: Leave your evil life. Quit your evil practices." But they ignored everything I said to them, stubbornly refused to listen.'
- 4 Do not be like your forefathers, to whom the earlier prophets proclaimed: This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'Turn from your evil ways and your evil practices.' But they would not listen or pay attention to me, declares the LORD.
- 5 "And where are your ancestors now? Dead and buried. And the prophets who preached to them? Also dead and buried. But the Message that my servants the prophets spoke, that isn't dead and buried.
- 5 Where are your forefathers now? And the prophets, do they live forever?
- 6 That Message did its work on your ancestors, did it not? It woke them up and they came back, saying, 'He did what he said he would do, sure enough. We didn't get by with a thing.'"

- 6 But did not my words and my decrees, which I commanded my servants the prophets, overtake your forefathers? "Then they repented and said, 'The LORD Almighty has done to us what our ways and practices deserve, just as he determined to do.' "
- 7 On the twenty-fourth day of the eleventh month in the second year of the reign of Darius, the Message of GOD was given to the prophet Zechariah son of Berechiah, son of Iddo:
- 7 On the twenty-fourth day of the eleventh month, the month of Shebat, in the second year of Darius, the word of the LORD came to the prophet Zechariah son of Berechiah, the son of Iddo.
- 8 One night I looked out and saw a man astride a red horse. He was in the shadows in a grove of birches. Behind him were more horses--a red, a chestnut, and a white.
- 8 During the night I had a vision--and there before me was a man riding a red horse! He was standing among the myrtle trees in a ravine. Behind him were red, brown and white horses.
- 9 I said, "Sir, what are these horses doing here? What's the meaning of this?" The Angel-Messenger said, "Let me show you."
- 9 I asked, "What are these, my lord?" The angel who was talking with me answered, "I will show you what they are."
- 10 Then the rider in the birch grove spoke up, "These are the riders that GOD sent to check things out on earth."
- 10 Then the man standing among the myrtle trees explained, "They are the ones the LORD has sent to go throughout the earth."
- 11 They reported their findings to the Angel of GOD in the birch grove: "We have looked over the whole earth and all is well. Everything's under control."
- 11 And they reported to the angel of the LORD, who was standing among the myrtle trees, "We have gone throughout the earth and found the whole world at rest and in peace."
- 12 The Angel of GOD reported back, "O GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, how long are you going to stay angry with Jerusalem and the cities of Judah? When are you going to let up? Isn't seventy years long enough?"
- 12 Then the angel of the LORD said, "LORD Almighty, how long will you withhold mercy from Jerusalem and from the towns of Judah, which you have been angry with these seventy years?"

13 GOD reassured the Angel-Messenger--good words, comforting words--
13 So the LORD spoke kind and comforting words to the angel who talked with me.
14 who then addressed me: "Tell them this. Tell them that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has spoken. This is GOD's Message: 'I care deeply for Jerusalem and Zion. I feel very possessive of them.'
14 Then the angel who was speaking to me said, "Proclaim this word: This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'I am very jealous for Jerusalem and Zion,
15 But I'm thoroughly angry with the godless nations that act as if they own the whole world. I was only moderately angry earlier, but now they've gone too far. I'm going into action.
15 but I am very angry with the nations that feel secure. I was only a little angry, but they added to the calamity.'
16 "'I've come back to Jerusalem, but with compassion this time.' This is GOD speaking. 'I'll see to it that my Temple is rebuilt.' A Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies! 'The rebuilding operation is already staked out.'
16 Therefore, this is what the LORD says: 'I will return to Jerusalem with mercy, and there my house will be rebuilt. And the measuring line will be stretched out over Jerusalem,' declares the LORD Almighty.
17 Say it again--a Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: 'My cities will prosper again, GOD will comfort Zion again, Jerusalem will be back in my favor again.'"
17 Proclaim further: This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'My towns will again overflow with prosperity, and the LORD will again comfort Zion and choose Jerusalem.'
18 I looked up, and was surprised by another vision: four horns!
18 Then I looked up--and there before me were four horns!
19 I asked the Messenger-Angel, "And what's the meaning of this?" He said, "These are the powers that have scattered Judah, Israel, and Jerusalem abroad."
19 I asked the angel who was speaking to me, "What are these?" He answered me, "These are the horns that scattered Judah, Israel and Jerusalem."
20 Then GOD expanded the vision to include four blacksmiths.

20 Then the LORD showed me four craftsmen.

21 I asked, "And what are these all about?" He said, "Since the 'horns' scattered Judah so badly that no one had any hope left, these blacksmiths have arrived to combat the horns. They'll dehorn the godless nations who used their horns to scatter Judah to the four winds."

21 I asked, "What are these coming to do?" He answered, "These are the horns that scattered Judah so that no one could raise his head, but the craftsmen have come to terrify them and throw down these horns of the nations who lifted up their horns against the land of Judah to scatter its people."

Zechariah 2

MSG

NIV

1 I looked up and was surprised to see a man holding a tape measure in his hand.

1 Then I looked up--and there before me was a man with a measuring line in his hand!

2 I said, "What are you up to?" "I'm on my way," he said, "to survey Jerusalem, to measure its width and length."

2 I asked, "Where are you going?" He answered me, "To measure Jerusalem, to find out how wide and how long it is."

3 Just then the Messenger-Angel on his way out met another angel coming in

3 Then the angel who was speaking to me left, and another angel came to meet him

4 and said, "Run! Tell the Surveyor, 'Jerusalem will burst its walls--bursting with people, bursting with animals.

4 and said to him: "Run, tell that young man, 'Jerusalem will be a city without walls because of the great number of men and livestock in it.

5 And I'll be right there with her'--GOD's Decree--'a wall of fire around unwall'd Jerusalem and a radiant presence within.'"

5 And I myself will be a wall of fire around it,' declares the LORD, 'and I will be its glory within.'

- 6 "Up on your feet! Get out of there--and now!" GOD says so. "Return from your far exile. I scattered you to the four winds." GOD's Decree.
- 6 Come! Come! Flee from the land of the north, declares the LORD, "for I have scattered you to the four winds of heaven," declares the LORD.
- 7 "Escape from Babylon, Zion, and come home--now!"
- 7 Come, O Zion! Escape, you who live in the Daughter of Babylon!
- 8 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, the One of Glory who sent me on my mission, commenting on the godless nations who stripped you and left you homeless, said, "Anyone who hits you, hits me--bloodies my nose, blackens my eye.
- 8 For this is what the LORD Almighty says: "After he has honored me and has sent me against the nations that have plundered you--for whoever touches you touches the apple of his eye--
- 9 Yes, and at the right time I'll give the signal and they'll be stripped and thrown out by their own servants." Then you'll know for sure that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies sent me on this mission.
- 9 I will surely raise my hand against them so that their slaves will plunder them. Then you will know that the LORD Almighty has sent me.
- 10 "Shout and celebrate, Daughter of Zion! I'm on my way. I'm moving into your neighborhood!" GOD's Decree.
- 10 Shout and be glad, O Daughter of Zion. For I am coming, and I will live among you, declares the LORD.
- 11 Many godless nations will be linked up with GOD at that time. ("They will become my family! I'll live in their homes!") And then you'll know for sure that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies sent me on this mission.
- 11 Many nations will be joined with the LORD in that day and will become my people. I will live among you and you will know that the LORD Almighty has sent me to you.
- 12 GOD will reclaim his Judah inheritance in the Holy Land. He'll again make clear that Jerusalem is his choice.
- 12 The LORD will inherit Judah as his portion in the holy land and will again choose Jerusalem.
- 13 Quiet, everyone! Shh! Silence before GOD. Something's afoot in his holy house. He's on the move!
- 13 Be still before the LORD, all mankind, because he has roused himself from his holy dwelling."

Zechariah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Next the Messenger-Angel showed me the high priest Joshua. He was standing before GOD's Angel where the Accuser showed up to accuse him.
- 1 Then he showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, and Satan standing at his right side to accuse him.
- 2 Then GOD said to the Accuser, "I, GOD, rebuke you, Accuser! I rebuke you and choose Jerusalem. Surprise! Everything is going up in flames, but I reach in and pull out Jerusalem!"
- 2 The LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke you, Satan! The LORD, who has chosen Jerusalem, rebuke you! Is not this man a burning stick snatched from the fire?"
- 3 Joshua, standing before the angel, was dressed in dirty clothes.
- 3 Now Joshua was dressed in filthy clothes as he stood before the angel.
- 4 The angel spoke to his attendants, "Get him out of those filthy clothes," and then said to Joshua, "Look, I've stripped you of your sin and dressed you up in clean clothes."
- 4 The angel said to those who were standing before him, "Take off his filthy clothes." Then he said to Joshua, "See, I have taken away your sin, and I will put rich garments on you."
- 5 I spoke up and said, "How about a clean new turban for his head also?" And they did it--put a clean new turban on his head. Then they finished dressing him, with GOD's Angel looking on.
- 5 Then I said, "Put a clean turban on his head." So they put a clean turban on his head and clothed him, while the angel of the LORD stood by.
- 6 GOD's Angel then charged Joshua,
- 6 The angel of the LORD gave this charge to Joshua:
- 7 "Orders from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: 'If you live the way I tell you and remain obedient in my service, then you'll make the decisions around here and oversee my affairs. And all my attendants standing here will be at your service.'
- 7 This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'If you will walk in my ways and keep my requirements, then you will govern my house and have charge

- of my courts, and I will give you a place among these standing here.
- 8 "'Careful, High Priest Joshua--both you and your friends sitting here with you, for your friends are in on this, too! Here's what I'm doing next: I'm introducing my servant Branch.
- 8 'Listen, O high priest Joshua and your associates seated before you, who are men symbolic of things to come: I am going to bring my servant, the Branch.
- 9 And note this: This stone that I'm placing before Joshua, a single stone with seven eyes'--Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies--'I'll engrave with these words: "I'll strip this land of its filthy sin, all at once, in a single day."
- 9 See, the stone I have set in front of Joshua! There are seven eyes on that one stone, and I will engrave an inscription on it,' says the LORD Almighty, 'and I will remove the sin of this land in a single day.
- 10 "'At that time, everyone will get along with one another, with friendly visits across the fence, friendly visits on one another's porches."
- 10 'In that day each of you will invite his neighbor to sit under his vine and fig tree,' declares the LORD Almighty.

Zechariah 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Messenger-Angel again called me to attention. It was like being wakened out of deep sleep.
- 1 Then the angel who talked with me returned and wakened me, as a man is wakened from his sleep.
- 2 He said, "What do you see?" I answered, "I see a lampstand of solid gold with a bowl on top. Seven lamps, each with seven spouts, are set on the bowl.
- 2 He asked me, "What do you see?" I answered, "I see a solid gold lampstand with a bowl at the top and seven lights on it, with seven channels to the lights.
- 3 And there are two olive trees, one on either side of the bowl."
- 3 Also there are two olive trees by it, one on the right of the bowl and the other on its left."

- 4 Then I asked the Messenger-Angel, "What does this mean, sir?"
- 4 I asked the angel who talked with me, "What are these, my lord?"
- 5 The Messenger-Angel said, "Can't you tell?" "No, sir," I said. Then he said,
- 5 He answered, "Do you not know what these are?" "No, my lord," I replied.
- 6 "This is GOD's Message to Zerubbabel: 'You can't force these things. They only come about through my Spirit,' says GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 6 So he said to me, "This is the word of the LORD to Zerubbabel: 'Not by might nor by power, but by my Spirit,' says the LORD Almighty.
- 7 'So, big mountain, who do you think you are? Next to Zerubbabel you're nothing but a molehill. He'll proceed to set the Cornerstone in place, accompanied by cheers: Yes! Yes! Do it!'"
- 7 What are you, O mighty mountain? Before Zerubbabel you will become level ground. Then he will bring out the capstone to shouts of 'God bless it! God bless it!'
- 8 After that, the Word of GOD came to me:
- 8 Then the word of the LORD came to me:
- 9 "Zerubbabel started rebuilding this Temple and he will complete it. That will be your confirmation that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies sent me to you.
- 9 The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the foundation of this temple; his hands will also complete it. Then you will know that the LORD Almighty has sent me to you.
- 10 Does anyone dare despise this day of small beginnings? They'll change their tune when they see Zerubbabel setting the last stone in place!"
- Going back to the vision, the Messenger-Angel said, "The seven lamps are the eyes of GOD probing the dark corners of the world like searchlights."
- 10 Who despises the day of small things? Men will rejoice when they see the plumb line in the hand of Zerubbabel. (These seven are the eyes of the LORD, which range throughout the earth.)"
- 11 "And the two olive trees on either side of the lampstand?" I asked. "What's the meaning of them?"

- 11 Then I asked the angel, "What are these two olive trees on the right and the left of the lampstand?"
- 12 And while you're at it, the two branches of the olive trees that feed oil to the lamps--what do they mean?"
- 12 Again I asked him, "What are these two olive branches beside the two gold pipes that pour out golden oil?"
- 13 He said, "You haven't figured that out?" I said, "No, sir."
- 13 He replied, "Do you not know what these are?" "No, my lord," I said.
- 14 He said, "These are the two who stand beside the Master of the whole earth and supply golden lamp oil worldwide."
- 14 So he said, "These are the two who are anointed to serve the Lord of all the earth."

Zechariah 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 I looked up again and saw--surprise!--a book on the wing! A book flying!
- 1 I looked again--and there before me was a flying scroll!
- 2 The Messenger-Angel said to me, "What do you see now?" I said, "I see a book flying, a huge book--thirty feet long and fifteen wide!"
- 2 He asked me, "What do you see?" I answered, "I see a flying scroll, thirty feet long and fifteen feet wide. "
- 3 He told me, "This book is the verdict going out worldwide against thieves and liars. The first half of the book disposes of everyone who steals; the second half takes care of everyone who lies.
- 3 And he said to me, "This is the curse that is going out over the whole land; for according to what it says on one side, every thief will be banished, and according to what it says on the other, everyone who swears falsely will be banished.
- 4 I launched it"--Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies--"and so it will fly into the house of every thief and every liar. It will land in each house and tear it down, timbers and stones."
- 4 The LORD Almighty declares, 'I will send it out, and it will enter the house of the thief and the house of him who swears falsely by my name.

- It will remain in his house and destroy it, both its timbers and its stones.'
- "
- 5 The Messenger-Angel appeared and said, "Look up. Tell me what you see."
- 5 Then the angel who was speaking to me came forward and said to me, "Look up and see what this is that is appearing."
- 6 I said, "What in the world is that?" He said, "This is a bushel basket on a journey. It holds the sin of everyone, everywhere."
- 6 I asked, "What is it?" He replied, "It is a measuring basket. " And he added, "This is the iniquity of the people throughout the land."
- 7 Then the lid made of lead was removed from the basket--and there was a woman sitting in it!
- 7 Then the cover of lead was raised, and there in the basket sat a woman!
- 8 He said, "This is Miss Wicked." He pushed her back down into the basket and clamped the lead lid over her.
- 8 He said, "This is wickedness," and he pushed her back into the basket and pushed the lead cover down over its mouth.
- 9 Then I looked up and to my surprise saw two women flying. On outstretched wings they airlifted the bushel basket into the sky.
- 9 Then I looked up--and there before me were two women, with the wind in their wings! They had wings like those of a stork, and they lifted up the basket between heaven and earth.
- 10 I said to the Messenger-Angel, "Where are they taking the bushel basket?"
- 10 Where are they taking the basket? I asked the angel who was speaking to me.
- 11 He said, "East to the land of Shinar. They will build a garage to house it. When it's finished, the basket will be stored there."
- 11 He replied, "To the country of Babylonia to build a house for it. When it is ready, the basket will be set there in its place."

Zechariah 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Once again I looked up--another strange sight! Four chariots charging out from between two mountains. The mountains were bronze.
- 1 I looked up again--and there before me were four chariots coming out from between two mountains--mountains of bronze!
- 2 The first chariot was drawn by red horses, the second chariot by black horses,
- 2 The first chariot had red horses, the second black,
- 3 the third chariot by white horses, and the fourth chariot by dappled horses. All the horses were powerful.
- 3 the third white, and the fourth dappled--all of them powerful.
- 4 I asked the Messenger-Angel, "Sir, what's the meaning here?"
- 4 I asked the angel who was speaking to me, "What are these, my lord?"
- 5 The angel answered, "These are the four winds of heaven, which originate with the Master of the whole earth.
- 5 The angel answered me, "These are the four spirits of heaven, going out from standing in the presence of the Lord of the whole world.
- 6 The black horses are headed north with the white ones right after them. The dappled horses are headed south."
- 6 The one with the black horses is going toward the north country, the one with the white horses toward the west, and the one with the dappled horses toward the south."
- 7 The powerful horses galloped out, bursting with energy, eager to patrol through the earth. The Messenger-Angel commanded: "On your way! Survey the earth!" and they were off in every direction.
- 7 When the powerful horses went out, they were straining to go throughout the earth. And he said, "Go throughout the earth!" So they went throughout the earth.
- 8 Then he called to me and said, "Look at them go! The ones going north are conveying a sense of my Spirit, serene and secure. No more trouble from that direction."
- 8 Then he called to me, "Look, those going toward the north country have given my Spirit rest in the land of the north."
- 9 Then this Message from GOD came to me:
- 9 The word of the LORD came to me:
- 10 "Take up a collection from the exiles. Target Heldai, Tobiah, and Jedaiah. They've just arrived from Babylon. You'll find them at the home

- of Josiah son of Zephaniah.
- 10 Take silver and gold from the exiles Heldai, Tobijah and Jedaiah, who have arrived from Babylon. Go the same day to the house of Josiah son of Zephaniah.
- 11 Collect silver and gold from them and fashion crowns. Place one on the head of Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest,
- 11 Take the silver and gold and make a crown, and set it on the head of the high priest, Joshua son of Jehozadak.
- 12 and give him this message: "'A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. Be alert. We have a man here whose name is Branch. He will branch out from where he is and build the Temple of GOD.
- 12 Tell him this is what the LORD Almighty says: 'Here is the man whose name is the Branch, and he will branch out from his place and build the temple of the LORD.
- 13 Yes, he's the one. He'll build the Temple of GOD. Then he'll assume the role of royalty, take his place on the throne and rule--a priest sitting on the throne!--showing that king and priest can coexist in harmony.'
- 13 It is he who will build the temple of the LORD, and he will be clothed with majesty and will sit and rule on his throne. And he will be a priest on his throne. And there will be harmony between the two.'
- 14 "The other crown will be in the Temple of GOD as a symbol of royalty, under the custodial care of Helem, Tobiah, Jedaiah, and Hen son of Zephaniah.
- 14 The crown will be given to Heldai, Tobijah, Jedaiah and Hen son of Zephaniah as a memorial in the temple of the LORD.
- 15 "People will come from faraway places to pitch in and rebuild the Temple of GOD. This will confirm that GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies did, in fact, send me to you. All this follows as you put your minds to a life of responsive obedience to the voice of your GOD."
- 15 Those who are far away will come and help to build the temple of the LORD, and you will know that the LORD Almighty has sent me to you. This will happen if you diligently obey the LORD your God."

Zechariah 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 On the fourth day of the ninth month, in the fourth year of the reign of King Darius, GOD's Message again came to Zechariah.
- 1 In the fourth year of King Darius, the word of the LORD came to Zechariah on the fourth day of the ninth month, the month of Kislev.
- 2 The town of Bethel had sent a delegation headed by Sarezzer and Regem-Melech to pray for GOD's blessing
- 2 The people of Bethel had sent Sharezer and Regem-Melech, together with their men, to entreat the LORD
- 3 and to confer with the priests of the Temple of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, and also with the prophets. They posed this question: "Should we plan for a day of mourning and abstinence next August, the seventieth anniversary of Jerusalem's fall, as we have been doing all these years?"
- 3 by asking the priests of the house of the LORD Almighty and the prophets, "Should I mourn and fast in the fifth month, as I have done for so many years?"
- 4 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies gave me this Message for them,
- 4 Then the word of the LORD Almighty came to me:
- 5 for all the people and for the priests: "When you held days of fasting every fifth and seventh month all these seventy years, were you doing it for me?
- 5 Ask all the people of the land and the priests, 'When you fasted and mourned in the fifth and seventh months for the past seventy years, was it really for me that you fasted?
- 6 And when you held feasts, was that for me? Hardly. You're interested in religion, I'm interested in people.
- 6 And when you were eating and drinking, were you not just feasting for yourselves?
- 7 "There's nothing new to say on the subject. Don't you still have the message of the earlier prophets from the time when Jerusalem was still a thriving, bustling city and the outlying countryside, the Negev and Shephelah, was populated?
- 7 Are these not the words the LORD proclaimed through the earlier prophets when Jerusalem and its surrounding towns were at rest and prosperous, and the Negev and the western foothills were settled?' "

- 8 [This is the message that GOD gave Zechariah.]
- 8 And the word of the LORD came again to Zechariah:
- 9 Well, the message hasn't changed. GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies said then and says now: "'Treat one another justly. Love your neighbors. Be compassionate with each other.
- 9 This is what the LORD Almighty says: 'Administer true justice; show mercy and compassion to one another.
- 10 Don't take advantage of widows, orphans, visitors, and the poor. Don't plot and scheme against one another--that's evil.'
- 10 Do not oppress the widow or the fatherless, the alien or the poor. In your hearts do not think evil of each other.'
- 11 "But did your ancestors listen? No, they set their jaws in defiance. They shut their ears.
- 11 But they refused to pay attention; stubbornly they turned their backs and stopped up their ears.
- 12 They steeled themselves against GOD's revelation and the Spirit-filled sermons preached by the earlier prophets by order of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. And GOD became angry, really angry,
- 12 They made their hearts as hard as flint and would not listen to the law or to the words that the LORD Almighty had sent by his Spirit through the earlier prophets. So the LORD Almighty was very angry.
- 13 because he told them everything plainly and they wouldn't listen to a word he said. "So [this is what GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies said]if they won't listen to me, I won't listen to them.
- 13 'When I called, they did not listen; so when they called, I would not listen,' says the LORD Almighty.
- 14 I scattered them to the four winds. They ended up strangers wherever they were. Their 'promised land' became a vacant lot--weeds and tin cans and thistles. Not a sign of life. They turned a dreamland into a wasteland."
- 14 'I scattered them with a whirlwind among all the nations, where they were strangers. The land was left so desolate behind them that no one could come or go. This is how they made the pleasant land desolate.' "

Zechariah 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 And then these Messages from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies:
- 1 Again the word of the LORD Almighty came to me.
- 2 "I am zealous for Zion--I care! I'm angry about Zion--I'm involved!" GOD's Message:
- 2 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "I am very jealous for Zion; I am burning with jealousy for her."
- 3 "I've come back to Zion, I've moved back to Jerusalem. Jerusalem's new names will be Truth City, and Mountain of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, and Mount Holiness."
- 3 This is what the LORD says: "I will return to Zion and dwell in Jerusalem. Then Jerusalem will be called the City of Truth, and the mountain of the LORD Almighty will be called the Holy Mountain."
- 4 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "Old men and old women will come back to Jerusalem, sit on benches on the streets and spin tales, move around safely with their canes--a good city to grow old in."
- 4 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "Once again men and women of ripe old age will sit in the streets of Jerusalem, each with cane in hand because of his age."
- 5 And boys and girls will fill the public parks, laughing and playing--a good city to grow up in."
- 5 The city streets will be filled with boys and girls playing there."
- 6 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "Do the problems of returning and rebuilding by just a few survivors seem too much? But is anything too much for me? Not if I have my say."
- 6 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "It may seem marvelous to the remnant of this people at that time, but will it seem marvelous to me?" declares the LORD Almighty.
- 7 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "I'll collect my people from countries to the east and countries to the west."
- 7 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "I will save my people from the countries of the east and the west."
- 8 I'll bring them back and move them into Jerusalem. They'll be my people and I'll be their God. I'll stick with them and do right by them." A

Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies:

- 8 I will bring them back to live in Jerusalem; they will be my people, and I will be faithful and righteous to them as their God."
- 9 "Get a grip on things. Hold tight, you who are listening to what I say through the preaching of the prophets. The Temple of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies has been reestablished. The Temple is being rebuilt.
- 9 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "You who now hear these words spoken by the prophets who were there when the foundation was laid for the house of the LORD Almighty, let your hands be strong so that the temple may be built.
- 10 We've come through a hard time: You worked for a pittance and were lucky to get that; the streets were dangerous; you could never let down your guard; I had turned the world into an armed camp.
- 10 Before that time there were no wages for man or beast. No one could go about his business safely because of his enemy, for I had turned every man against his neighbor.
- 11 "But things have changed. I'm taking the side of my core of surviving people:
- 11 But now I will not deal with the remnant of this people as I did in the past," declares the LORD Almighty.
- 12 Sowing and harvesting will resume, Vines will grow grapes, Gardens will flourish, Dew and rain will make everything green. "My core survivors will get everything they need--and more.
- 12 The seed will grow well, the vine will yield its fruit, the ground will produce its crops, and the heavens will drop their dew. I will give all these things as an inheritance to the remnant of this people.
- 13 You've gotten a reputation as a bad-news people, you people of Judah and Israel, but I'm coming to save you. From now on, you're the good-news people. Don't be afraid. Keep a firm grip on what I'm doing."
- 13 As you have been an object of cursing among the nations, O Judah and Israel, so will I save you, and you will be a blessing. Do not be afraid, but let your hands be strong."
- 14 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "In the same way that I decided to punish you when your ancestors made me angry, and didn't pull my punches,

- 14 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "Just as I had determined to bring disaster upon you and showed no pity when your fathers angered me," says the LORD Almighty,
- 15 at this time I've decided to bless Jerusalem and the country of Judah. Don't be afraid.
- 15 so now I have determined to do good again to Jerusalem and Judah. Do not be afraid.
- 16 And now here's what I want you to do: Tell the truth, the whole truth, when you speak. Do the right thing by one another, both personally and in your courts.
- 16 These are the things you are to do: Speak the truth to each other, and render true and sound judgment in your courts;
- 17 Don't cook up plans to take unfair advantage of others. Don't do or say what isn't so. I hate all that stuff. Keep your lives simple and honest." Decree of GOD.
- 17 do not plot evil against your neighbor, and do not love to swear falsely. I hate all this," declares the LORD.
- 18 Again I received a Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies:
- 18 Again the word of the LORD Almighty came to me.
- 19 "The days of mourning set for the fourth, fifth, seventh, and tenth months will be turned into days of feasting for Judah--celebration and holiday. Embrace truth! Love peace!"
- 19 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "The fasts of the fourth, fifth, seventh and tenth months will become joyful and glad occasions and happy festivals for Judah. Therefore love truth and peace."
- 20 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "People and their leaders will come from all over to see what's going on.
- 20 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "Many peoples and the inhabitants of many cities will yet come,
- 21 The leaders will confer with one another: 'Shouldn't we try to get in on this? Get in on GOD's blessings? Pray to GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies? What's keeping us? Let's go!'
- 21 and the inhabitants of one city will go to another and say, 'Let us go at once to entreat the LORD and seek the LORD Almighty. I myself am going.'

- 22 "Lots of people, powerful nations--they'll come to Jerusalem looking for what they can get from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, looking to get a blessing from GOD."
- 22 And many peoples and powerful nations will come to Jerusalem to seek the LORD Almighty and to entreat him."
- 23 A Message from GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies: "At that time, ten men speaking a variety of languages will grab the sleeve of one Jew, hold tight, and say, 'Let us go with you. We've heard that God is with you.'"
- 23 This is what the LORD Almighty says: "In those days ten men from all languages and nations will take firm hold of one Jew by the hem of his robe and say, 'Let us go with you, because we have heard that God is with you.' "

Zechariah 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 War Bulletin: GOD's Message challenges the country of Hadrach. It will settle on Damascus. The whole world has its eyes on GOD. Israel isn't the only one.
- 1 An Oracle The word of the LORD is against the land of Hadrach and will rest upon Damascus-- for the eyes of men and all the tribes of Israel are on the LORD--
- 2 That includes Hamath at the border, and Tyre and Sidon, clever as they think they are.
- 2 and upon Hamath too, which borders on it, and upon Tyre and Sidon, though they are very skillful.
- 3 Tyre has put together quite a kingdom for herself; she has stacked up silver like cordwood, piled gold high as haystacks.
- 3 Tyre has built herself a stronghold; she has heaped up silver like dust, and gold like the dirt of the streets.
- 4 But God will certainly bankrupt her; he will dump all that wealth into the ocean and burn up what's left in a big fire.
- 4 But the Lord will take away her possessions and destroy her power on the sea, and she will be consumed by fire.

- 5 Ashkelon will see it and panic, Gaza will wring its hands, Ekron will face a dead end. Gaza's king will die. Ashkelon will be emptied out,
- 5 Ashkelon will see it and fear; Gaza will writhe in agony, and Ekron too, for her hope will wither. Gaza will lose her king and Ashkelon will be deserted.
- 6 And a villain will take over in Ashdod. "I'll take proud Philistia down a peg:
- 6 Foreigners will occupy Ashdod, and I will cut off the pride of the Philistines.
- 7 I'll make him spit out his bloody booty and abandon his vile ways." What's left will be all God's--a core of survivors, a family brought together in Judah-- But enemies like Ekron will go the way of the Jebusites, into the dustbin of history.
- 7 I will take the blood from their mouths, the forbidden food from between their teeth. Those who are left will belong to our God and become leaders in Judah, and Ekron will be like the Jebusites.
- 8 "I will set up camp in my home country and defend it against invaders. Nobody is going to hurt my people ever again. I'm keeping my eye on them.
- 8 But I will defend my house against marauding forces. Never again will an oppressor overrun my people, for now I am keeping watch.
- 9 "Shout and cheer, Daughter Zion! Raise the roof, Daughter Jerusalem! Your king is coming! a good king who makes all things right, a humble king riding a donkey, a mere colt of a donkey.
- 9 Rejoice greatly, O Daughter of Zion! Shout, Daughter of Jerusalem! See, your king comes to you, righteous and having salvation, gentle and riding on a donkey, on a colt, the foal of a donkey.
- 10 I've had it with war--no more chariots in Ephraim, no more war horses in Jerusalem, no more swords and spears, bows and arrows. He will offer peace to the nations, a peaceful rule worldwide, from the four winds to the seven seas.
- 10 I will take away the chariots from Ephraim and the war-horses from Jerusalem, and the battle bow will be broken. He will proclaim peace to the nations. His rule will extend from sea to sea and from the River to the ends of the earth.

- 11 "And you, because of my blood covenant with you, I'll release your prisoners from their hopeless cells.
- 11 As for you, because of the blood of my covenant with you, I will free your prisoners from the waterless pit.
- 12 Come home, hope-filled prisoners! This very day I'm declaring a double bonus-- everything you lost returned twice-over!
- 12 Return to your fortress, O prisoners of hope; even now I announce that I will restore twice as much to you.
- 13 Judah is now my weapon, the bow I'll pull, setting Ephraim as an arrow to the string. I'll wake up your sons, O Zion, to counter your sons, O Greece. From now on people are my swords."
- 13 I will bend Judah as I bend my bow and fill it with Ephraim. I will rouse your sons, O Zion, against your sons, O Greece, and make you like a warrior's sword.
- 14 Then GOD will come into view, his arrows flashing like lightning! Master GOD will blast his trumpet and set out in a whirlwind.
- 14 Then the LORD will appear over them; his arrow will flash like lightning. The Sovereign LORD will sound the trumpet; he will march in the storms of the south,
- 15 GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will protect them-- all-out war, The war to end all wars, no holds barred.
- 15 and the LORD Almighty will shield them. They will destroy and overcome with slingstones. They will drink and roar as with wine; they will be full like a bowl used for sprinkling the corners of the altar.
- 16 Their GOD will save the day. He'll rescue them. They'll become like sheep, gentle and soft, Or like gemstones in a crown, catching all the colors of the sun.
- 16 The LORD their God will save them on that day as the flock of his people. They will sparkle in his land like jewels in a crown.
- 17 Then how they'll shine! shimmer! glow! the young men robust, the young women lovely!
- 17 How attractive and beautiful they will be! Grain will make the young men thrive, and new wine the young women.

Zechariah 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Pray to GOD for rain--it's time for the spring rain-- to GOD, the rainmaker, Spring thunderstorm maker, maker of grain and barley.
- 1 Ask the LORD for rain in the springtime; it is the LORD who makes the storm clouds. He gives showers of rain to men, and plants of the field to everyone.
- 2 "Store-bought gods babble gibberish. Religious experts spout rubbish. They pontificate hot air. Their prescriptions are nothing but smoke. And so the people wander like lost sheep, poor lost sheep without a shepherd.
- 2 The idols speak deceit, diviners see visions that lie; they tell dreams that are false, they give comfort in vain. Therefore the people wander like sheep oppressed for lack of a shepherd.
- 3 I'm furious with the so-called shepherds. They're worse than billy goats, and I'll treat them like goats." GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies will step in and take care of his flock, the people of Judah. He'll revive their spirits, make them proud to be on God's side.
- 3 My anger burns against the shepherds, and I will punish the leaders; for the LORD Almighty will care for his flock, the house of Judah, and make them like a proud horse in battle.
- 4 God will use them in his work of rebuilding, use them as foundations and pillars, Use them as tools and instruments, use them to oversee his work.
- 4 From Judah will come the cornerstone, from him the tent peg, from him the battle bow, from him every ruler.
- 5 They'll be a workforce to be proud of, working as one, their heads held high, striding through swamps and mud, Courageous and vigorous because GOD is with them, undeterred by the world's thugs.
- 5 Together they will be like mighty men trampling the muddy streets in battle. Because the LORD is with them, they will fight and overthrow the horsemen.
- 6 "I'll put muscle in the people of Judah; I'll save the people of Joseph. I know their pain and will make them good as new. They'll get a fresh start, as if nothing had ever happened. And why? Because I am their very own GOD, I'll do what needs to be done for them.
- 6 I will strengthen the house of Judah and save the house of Joseph. I will restore them because I have compassion on them. They will be as though

- I had not rejected them, for I am the LORD their God and I will answer them.
- 7 The people of Ephraim will be famous, their lives brimming with joy. Their children will get in on it, too-- oh, let them feel blessed by GOD!
- 7 The Ephraimites will become like mighty men, and their hearts will be glad as with wine. Their children will see it and be joyful; their hearts will rejoice in the LORD.
- 8 I'll whistle and they'll all come running. I've set them free--oh, how they'll flourish!
- 8 I will signal for them and gather them in. Surely I will redeem them; they will be as numerous as before.
- 9 Even though I scattered them to the far corners of earth, they'll remember me in the faraway places. They'll keep the story alive in their children, and they will come back.
- 9 Though I scatter them among the peoples, yet in distant lands they will remember me. They and their children will survive, and they will return.
- 10 I'll bring them back from the Egyptian west and round them up from the Assyrian east. I'll bring them back to sweet Gilead, back to leafy Lebanon. Every square foot of land will be marked by homecoming.
- 10 I will bring them back from Egypt and gather them from Assyria. I will bring them to Gilead and Lebanon, and there will not be room enough for them.
- 11 They'll sail through troubled seas, brush aside brash ocean waves. Roaring rivers will turn to a trickle. Gaudy Assyria will be stripped bare, bully Egypt exposed as a fraud.
- 11 They will pass through the sea of trouble; the surging sea will be subdued and all the depths of the Nile will dry up. Assyria's pride will be brought down and Egypt's scepter will pass away.
- 12 But my people--oh, I'll make them strong, GOD-strong! and they'll live my way." GOD says so!
- 12 I will strengthen them in the LORD and in his name they will walk," declares the LORD.

Zechariah 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 Open your borders to the immigrants, proud Lebanon! Your sentinel trees will burn.
- 1 Open your doors, O Lebanon, so that fire may devour your cedars!
- 2 Weep, great pine trees! Mourn, you sister cedars! Your towering trees are cordwood. Weep Bashan oak trees! Your thick forest is now a field of stumps.
- 2 Wail, O pine tree, for the cedar has fallen; the stately trees are ruined! Wail, oaks of Bashan; the dense forest has been cut down!
- 3 Do you hear the wailing of shepherds? They've lost everything they once owned. Do you hear the outrage of the lions? The mighty jungle of the Jordan is wasted.
- 3 Listen to the wail of the shepherds; their rich pastures are destroyed! Listen to the roar of the lions; the lush thicket of the Jordan is ruined!
- 4 Make room for the returning exiles! GOD commanded me, "Shepherd the sheep that are soon to be slaughtered.
- 4 This is what the LORD my God says: "Pasture the flock marked for slaughter.
- 5 The people who buy them will butcher them for quick and easy money. What's worse, they'll get away with it. The people who sell them will say, 'Lucky me! God's on my side; I've got it made!' They have shepherds who couldn't care less about them."
- 5 Their buyers slaughter them and go unpunished. Those who sell them say, 'Praise the LORD, I am rich!' Their own shepherds do not spare them.
- 6 GOD's Decree: "I'm washing my hands of the people of this land. From now on they're all on their own. It's dog-eat-dog, survival of the fittest, and the devil take the hindmost. Don't look for help from me."
- 6 For I will no longer have pity on the people of the land," declares the LORD. "I will hand everyone over to his neighbor and his king. They will oppress the land, and I will not rescue them from their hands."
- 7 So I took over from the crass, money-grubbing owners, and shepherded the sheep marked for slaughter. I got myself two shepherd staffs. I named one Lovely and the other Harmony. Then I went to work shepherding the sheep.

- 7 So I pastured the flock marked for slaughter, particularly the oppressed of the flock. Then I took two staffs and called one Favor and the other Union, and I pastured the flock.
- 8 Within a month I got rid of the corrupt shepherds. I got tired of putting up with them--and they couldn't stand me.
- 8 In one month I got rid of the three shepherds. The flock detested me, and I grew weary of them
- 9 And then I got tired of the sheep and said, "I've had it with you--no more shepherding from me. If you die, you die; if you're attacked, you're attacked. Whoever survives can eat what's left."
- 9 and said, "I will not be your shepherd. Let the dying die, and the perishing perish. Let those who are left eat one another's flesh."
- 10 Then I took the staff named Lovely and broke it across my knee, breaking the beautiful covenant I had made with all the peoples.
- 10 Then I took my staff called Favor and broke it, revoking the covenant I had made with all the nations.
- 11 In one stroke, both staff and covenant were broken. The money-hungry owners saw me do it and knew GOD was behind it.
- 11 It was revoked on that day, and so the afflicted of the flock who were watching me knew it was the word of the LORD.
- 12 Then I addressed them: "Pay me what you think I'm worth." They paid me an insulting sum, counting out thirty silver coins.
- 12 I told them, "If you think it best, give me my pay; but if not, keep it." So they paid me thirty pieces of silver.
- 13 GOD told me, "Throw it in the poor box." This stingy wage was all they thought of me and my work! So I took the thirty silver coins and threw them into the poor box in GOD's Temple.
- 13 And the LORD said to me, "Throw it to the potter"--the handsome price at which they priced me! So I took the thirty pieces of silver and threw them into the house of the LORD to the potter.
- 14 Then I broke the other staff, Harmony, across my knee, breaking the concord between Judah and Israel.
- 14 Then I broke my second staff called Union, breaking the brotherhood between Judah and Israel.
- 15 GOD then said, "Dress up like a stupid shepherd.

- 15 Then the LORD said to me, "Take again the equipment of a foolish shepherd.
- 16 I'm going to install just such a shepherd in this land--a shepherd indifferent to victims, who ignores the lost, abandons the injured, and disdains decent citizens. He'll only be in it for what he can get out of it, using and abusing any and all.
- 16 For I am going to raise up a shepherd over the land who will not care for the lost, or seek the young, or heal the injured, or feed the healthy, but will eat the meat of the choice sheep, tearing off their hoofs.
- 17 "Doom to you, useless shepherd, walking off and leaving the sheep! A curse on your arm! A curse on your right eye! Your arm will hang limp and useless. Your right eye will go stone blind."
- 17 Woe to the worthless shepherd, who deserts the flock! May the sword strike his arm and his right eye! May his arm be completely withered, his right eye totally blinded! An Oracle

Zechariah 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 War Bulletin: GOD's Message concerning Israel, GOD's Decree--the very GOD who threw the skies into space, set earth on a firm foundation, and breathed his own life into men and women:
- 1 This is the word of the LORD concerning Israel. The LORD, who stretches out the heavens, who lays the foundation of the earth, and who forms the spirit of man within him, declares:
- 2 "Watch for this: I'm about to turn Jerusalem into a cup of strong drink that will have the people who have set siege to Judah and Jerusalem staggering in a drunken stupor.
- 2 I am going to make Jerusalem a cup that sends all the surrounding peoples reeling. Judah will be besieged as well as Jerusalem.
- 3 "On the Big Day, I'll turn Jerusalem into a huge stone blocking the way for everyone. All who try to lift it will rupture themselves. All the pagan nations will come together and try to get rid of it.
- 3 On that day, when all the nations of the earth are gathered against her, I will make Jerusalem an immovable rock for all the nations. All who try

to move it will injure themselves.

- 4 "On the Big Day"--this is GOD speaking--"I'll throw all the war horses into a crazed panic, and their riders along with them. But I'll keep my eye on Judah, watching out for her at the same time that I make the enemy horses go blind.
- 4 On that day I will strike every horse with panic and its rider with madness," declares the LORD. "I will keep a watchful eye over the house of Judah, but I will blind all the horses of the nations.
- 5 The families of Judah will then realize, 'Why, our leaders are strong and able through GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, their personal God.'
- 5 Then the leaders of Judah will say in their hearts, 'The people of Jerusalem are strong, because the LORD Almighty is their God.'
- 6 "On the Big Day, I'll turn the families of Judah into something like a burning match in a tinder-dry forest, like a fiercely flaming torch in a barn full of hay. They'll burn up everything and everyone in sight--people to the right, people to the left--while Jerusalem fills up with people moving in and making themselves at home--home again in Jerusalem.
- 6 On that day I will make the leaders of Judah like a firepot in a woodpile, like a flaming torch among sheaves. They will consume right and left all the surrounding peoples, but Jerusalem will remain intact in her place.
- 7 "I, GOD, will begin by restoring the common households of Judah so that the glory of David's family and the leaders in Jerusalem won't overshadow the ordinary people in Judah.
- 7 The LORD will save the dwellings of Judah first, so that the honor of the house of David and of Jerusalem's inhabitants may not be greater than that of Judah.
- 8 On the Big Day, I'll look after everyone who lives in Jerusalem so that the lowliest, weakest person will be as glorious as David and the family of David itself will be godlike, like the Angel of GOD leading the people.
- 8 On that day the LORD will shield those who live in Jerusalem, so that the feeblest among them will be like David, and the house of David will be like God, like the Angel of the LORD going before them.
- 9 "On the Big Day, I'll make a clean sweep of all the godless nations that fought against Jerusalem.

- 9 On that day I will set out to destroy all the nations that attack Jerusalem.
- 10 "Next I'll deal with the family of David and those who live in Jerusalem. I'll pour a spirit of grace and prayer over them. They'll then be able to recognize me as the One they so grievously wounded--that piercing spear-thrust! And they'll weep--oh, how they'll weep! Deep mourning as of a parent grieving the loss of the firstborn child.
- 10 And I will pour out on the house of David and the inhabitants of Jerusalem a spirit of grace and supplication. They will look on me, the one they have pierced, and they will mourn for him as one mourns for an only child, and grieve bitterly for him as one grieves for a firstborn son.
- 11 The lamentation in Jerusalem that day will be massive, as famous as the lamentation over Hadad-Rimmon on the fields of Megiddo:
- 11 On that day the weeping in Jerusalem will be great, like the weeping of Hadad Rimmon in the plain of Megiddo.
- 12 Everyone will weep and grieve, the land and everyone in it: The family of David off by itself and their women off by themselves; The family of Nathan off by itself and their women off by themselves;
- 12 The land will mourn, each clan by itself, with their wives by themselves: the clan of the house of David and their wives, the clan of the house of Nathan and their wives,
- 13 The family of Levi off by itself and their women off by themselves; The family of Shimei off by itself and their women off by themselves;
- 13 the clan of the house of Levi and their wives, the clan of Shimei and their wives,
- 14 And all the rest of the families off by themselves and their women off by themselves.
- 14 and all the rest of the clans and their wives.

Zechariah 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 "On the Big Day, a fountain will be opened for the family of David and all the leaders of Jerusalem for washing away their sins, for scrubbing their stained and soiled lives clean.

- 1 On that day a fountain will be opened to the house of David and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, to cleanse them from sin and impurity.
- 2 "On the Big Day"--this is GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies speaking--"I will wipe out the store-bought gods, erase their names from memory. People will forget they ever heard of them. And I'll get rid of the prophets who polluted the air with their diseased words.
- 2 On that day, I will banish the names of the idols from the land, and they will be remembered no more, declares the LORD Almighty. "I will remove both the prophets and the spirit of impurity from the land.
- 3 If anyone dares persist in spreading diseased, polluting words, his very own parents will step in and say, 'That's it! You're finished! Your lies about GOD put everyone in danger,' and then they'll stab him to death in the very act of prophesying lies about GOD--his own parents, mind you!
- 3 And if anyone still prophesies, his father and mother, to whom he was born, will say to him, 'You must die, because you have told lies in the LORD's name.' When he prophesies, his own parents will stab him.
- 4 "On the Big Day, the lying prophets will be publicly exposed and humiliated. Then they'll wish they'd never swindled people with their 'visions.' No more masquerading in prophet clothes.
- 4 On that day every prophet will be ashamed of his prophetic vision. He will not put on a prophet's garment of hair in order to deceive.
- 5 But they'll deny they've even heard of such things: 'Me, a prophet? Not me. I'm a farmer--grew up on the farm.'
- 5 He will say, 'I am not a prophet. I am a farmer; the land has been my livelihood since my youth. '
- 6 And if someone says, 'And so where did you get that black eye?' they'll say, 'I ran into a door at a friend's house.'
- 6 If someone asks him, 'What are these wounds on your body?' he will answer, 'The wounds I was given at the house of my friends.'
- 7 "Sword, get moving against my shepherd, against my close associate!" Decree of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. "Kill the shepherd! Scatter the sheep! The back of my hand against even the lambs!
- 7 Awake, O sword, against my shepherd, against the man who is close to me! declares the LORD Almighty. "Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered, and I will turn my hand against the little ones.

- 8 All across the country"--GOD's Decree-- "two-thirds will be devastated and one-third survive.
- 8 In the whole land," declares the LORD, "two-thirds will be struck down and perish; yet one-third will be left in it.
- 9 I'll deliver the surviving third to the refinery fires. I'll refine them as silver is refined, test them for purity as gold is tested. Then they'll pray to me by name and I'll answer them personally. I'll say, 'That's my people.' They'll say, 'GOD--my God!'"
- 9 This third I will bring into the fire; I will refine them like silver and test them like gold. They will call on my name and I will answer them; I will say, 'They are my people,' and they will say, 'The LORD is our God.' "

Zechariah 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Note well: GOD's Judgment Day is on the way: "Plunder will be piled high and handed out.
- 1 A day of the LORD is coming when your plunder will be divided among you.
- 2 I'm bringing all the godless nations to war against Jerusalem-- Houses plundered, women raped, Half the city taken into exile, the other half left behind."
- 2 I will gather all the nations to Jerusalem to fight against it; the city will be captured, the houses ransacked, and the women raped. Half of the city will go into exile, but the rest of the people will not be taken from the city.
- 3 But then GOD will march out against the godless nations and fight--a great war!
- 3 Then the LORD will go out and fight against those nations, as he fights in the day of battle.
- 4 That's the Day he'll take his stand on the Mount of Olives, facing Jerusalem from the east. The Mount of Olives will be split right down the middle, from east to west, leaving a wide valley. Half the mountain will shift north, the other half south.

- 4 On that day his feet will stand on the Mount of Olives, east of Jerusalem, and the Mount of Olives will be split in two from east to west, forming a great valley, with half of the mountain moving north and half moving south.
- 5 Then you will run for your lives down the valley, your escape route that will take you all the way to Azal. You'll run for your lives, just as you ran on the day of the great earthquake in the days of Uzziah, king of Judah. Then my GOD will arrive and all the holy angels with him.
- 5 You will flee by my mountain valley, for it will extend to Azel. You will flee as you fled from the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah. Then the LORD my God will come, and all the holy ones with him.
- 6 What a Day that will be! No more cold nights--in fact, no more nights!
- 6 On that day there will be no light, no cold or frost.
- 7 The Day is coming--the timing is GOD's--when it will be continuous day. Every evening will be a fresh morning.
- 7 It will be a unique day, without daytime or nighttime--a day known to the LORD. When evening comes, there will be light.
- 8 What a Day that will be! Fresh flowing rivers out of Jerusalem, half to the eastern sea, half to the western sea, flowing year-round, summer and winter!
- 8 On that day living water will flow out from Jerusalem, half to the eastern sea and half to the western sea, in summer and in winter.
- 9 GOD will be king over all the earth, one GOD and only one. What a Day that will be!
- 9 The LORD will be king over the whole earth. On that day there will be one LORD, and his name the only name.
- 10 The land will stretch out spaciouly around Jerusalem--to Geba in the north and Rimmon in the south, with Jerusalem towering at the center, and the commanding city gates--Gate of Benjamin to First Gate to Corner Gate to Hananel Tower to the Royal Winery--ringing the city
- 10 The whole land, from Geba to Rimmon, south of Jerusalem, will become like the Arabah. But Jerusalem will be raised up and remain in its place, from the Benjamin Gate to the site of the First Gate, to the Corner Gate, and from the Tower of Hananel to the royal winepresses.
- 11 full of people. Never again will Jerusalem be totally destroyed. From now on it will be a safe city.

- 11 It will be inhabited; never again will it be destroyed. Jerusalem will be secure.
- 12 But this is what will happen to all who fought against Jerusalem: GOD will visit them with a terrible plague. People's flesh will rot off their bones while they are walking around; their eyes will rot in their sockets and their tongues in their mouths; people will be dying on their feet!
- 12 This is the plague with which the LORD will strike all the nations that fought against Jerusalem: Their flesh will rot while they are still standing on their feet, their eyes will rot in their sockets, and their tongues will rot in their mouths.
- 13 Mass hysteria when that happens--total panic! Fellow soldiers fighting and killing each other--holy terror!
- 13 On that day men will be stricken by the LORD with great panic. Each man will seize the hand of another, and they will attack each other.
- 14 And then Judah will jump into the fray! Treasures from all the nations will be piled high--gold, silver, the latest fashions.
- 14 Judah too will fight at Jerusalem. The wealth of all the surrounding nations will be collected--great quantities of gold and silver and clothing.
- 15 The plague will also hit the animals--horses, mules, camels, donkeys. Everything alive in the military camps will be hit by the plague.
- 15 A similar plague will strike the horses and mules, the camels and donkeys, and all the animals in those camps.
- 16 All the survivors from the godless nations that fought against Jerusalem will travel to Jerusalem every year to worship the King, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, and celebrate the Feast of Booths.
- 16 Then the survivors from all the nations that have attacked Jerusalem will go up year after year to worship the King, the LORD Almighty, and to celebrate the Feast of Tabernacles.
- 17 If any of these survivors fail to make the annual pilgrimage to Jerusalem to worship the King, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, there will be no rain.
- 17 If any of the peoples of the earth do not go up to Jerusalem to worship the King, the LORD Almighty, they will have no rain.
- 18 If the Egyptians don't make the pilgrimage and worship, there will be no rain for them. Every nation that does not go up to celebrate the Feast of Booths will be hit with the plague.

- 18 If the Egyptian people do not go up and take part, they will have no rain. The LORD will bring on them the plague he inflicts on the nations that do not go up to celebrate the Feast of Tabernacles.
- 19 Egypt and any other nation that does not make pilgrimage to celebrate the Feast of Booths gets punished.
- 19 This will be the punishment of Egypt and the punishment of all the nations that do not go up to celebrate the Feast of Tabernacles.
- 20 On that Day, the Big Day, all the horses' harness bells will be inscribed "Holy to GOD." The cooking pots in the Temple of GOD will be as sacred as chalices and plates on the altar.
- 20 On that day HOLY TO THE LORD will be inscribed on the bells of the horses, and the cooking pots in the LORD's house will be like the sacred bowls in front of the altar.
- 21 In fact, all the pots and pans in all the kitchens of Jerusalem and Judah will be holy to GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies. People who come to worship, preparing meals and sacrifices, will use them. On that Big Day there will be no buying or selling in the Temple of GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 21 Every pot in Jerusalem and Judah will be holy to the LORD Almighty, and all who come to sacrifice will take some of the pots and cook in them. And on that day there will no longer be a Canaanite in the house of the LORD Almighty.